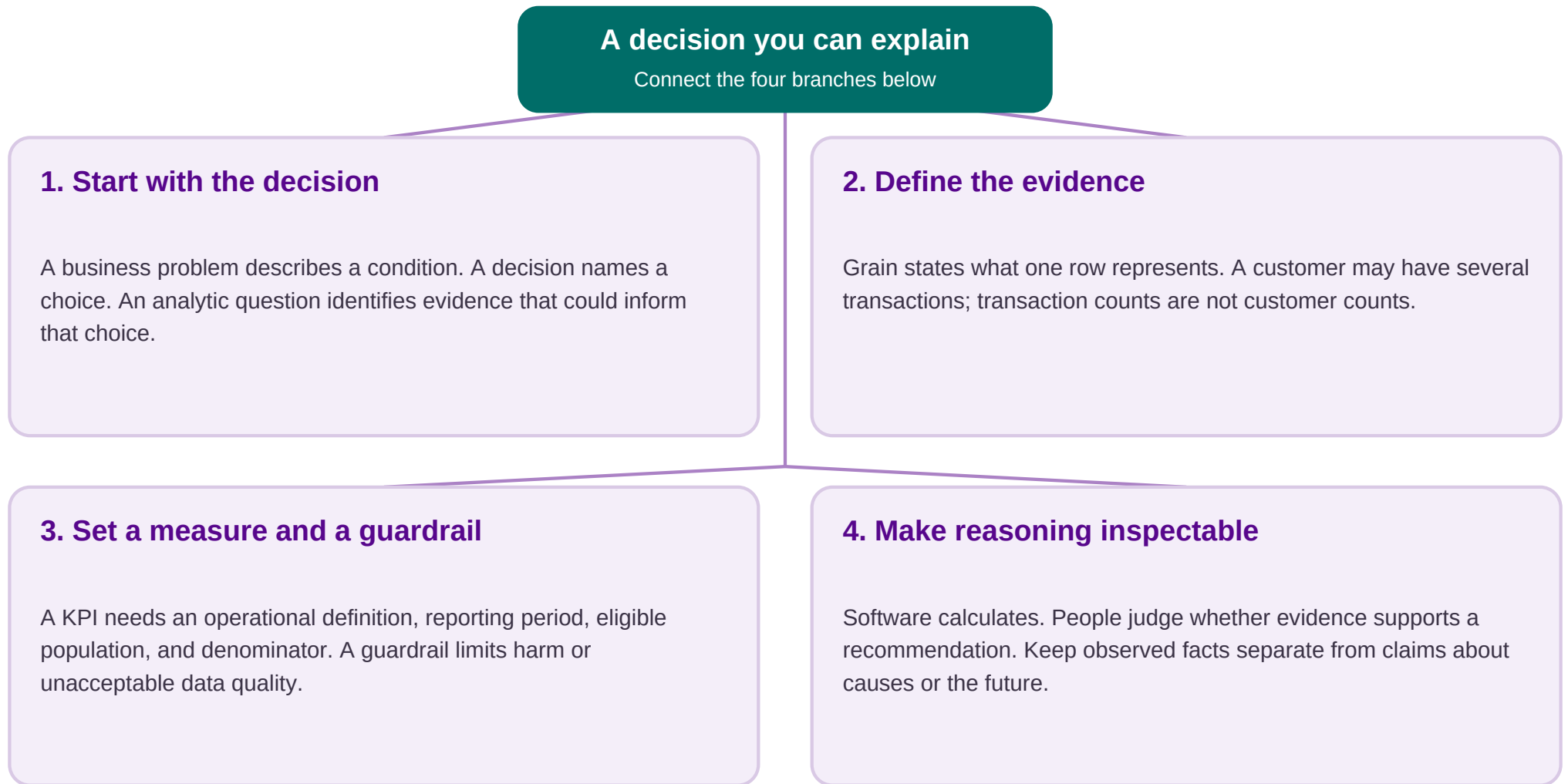


# Ask a question worth answering



# Start with the decision

**Concern > stakeholder > action > evidence**

## The connection

A business problem describes a condition. A decision names a choice. An analytic question identifies evidence that could inform that choice.

## A business example

For a fictional museum café, ask whether next month's weekend staffing should change, then identify which service measure could inform that choice.

## Explain it without looking

Name the observational unit, the evidence needed, and one limitation. Connect this branch to the next decision in the session.

# Define the evidence

**Population > grain > variable > provenance**

## The connection

Grain states what one row represents. A customer may have several transactions; transaction counts are not customer counts.

## A business example

A row for each café visit supports a visit-level wait measure. Line-item rows must be reconciled before counting visits.

## Explain it without looking

Name the observational unit, the evidence needed, and one limitation. Connect this branch to the next decision in the session.

# Set a measure and a guardrail

**Numerator / eligible denominator > unit > target**

## The connection

A KPI needs an operational definition, reporting period, eligible population, and denominator. A guardrail limits harm or unacceptable data quality.

## A business example

Pair a service target with a missing-wait guardrail so a good rate cannot hide poor records.

## Explain it without looking

Name the observational unit, the evidence needed, and one limitation. Connect this branch to the next decision in the session.

# Make reasoning inspectable

**Observation > inference > assumption > next action**

## The connection

Software calculates. People judge whether evidence supports a recommendation. Keep observed facts separate from claims about causes or the future.

## A business example

Report what the available visits show, explain uncertainty, and propose a bounded check before a permanent decision.

## Explain it without looking

Name the observational unit, the evidence needed, and one limitation. Connect this branch to the next decision in the session.